accessibility, so the first computational checks test for completeness of the metadata that is checked in, particularly fields such as description, business unit, owner, and the like.

The result of the computational check is then played back to the data product owner who registers the product so they have a chance to correct possible mistakes. This is a simple version of federated computational governance.

But what exactly is a platform in general, and why did this one emerge as our first solution?

7.1.1 Platform definition

We will use a generic definition of *platform* that unifies many current definitions. Economists tend to define platforms this way.

DEFINITION A *platform* mediates between different parties. Its purpose is to make interaction faster, easier, better, more valuable, and more frictionless.

For every platform, we need to identify at least three things:

- Which *parties* are mediated between?
- Which *interactions* are taking place through the platform?
- How does each party *interact with the platform*? How does the "mediation" work?

Let's answer these questions for our MVP platform.

APPLICATION TO OUR PLATFORM

If we look at our platform MVP in our architecture diagrams, we can quickly see interactions. However, the platform already abstracts a few things away. So let's take a close look at figure 7.2.